

YOUR FULL REPORT

Are you controlling?

Anxious influence

Score band: 14–26 points · Relationships

What this report covers

A practical plan for managing the anxiety that can turn good intentions into pressure or over-involvement.

Inside:

1. The uncertainty that drives control
2. Requests that leave room for a real no
3. How to stop after stating a concern once

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Your result

Anxious influence (14–26 points)

You may try to steer outcomes when uncertainty is uncomfortable. Your intent may be protection, but pressure can still shrink another person's freedom.

Try this next

State your concern once, then name the choice that belongs to the other person.

Your practical guide

A practical plan for managing the anxiety that can turn good intentions into pressure or over-involvement.

1 The uncertainty that drives control

Control at this level is usually anxiety wearing a helpful costume. The engine is uncertainty you cannot tolerate: a partner's vague plans, a teenager's choices, a project's loose ends, silence where you wanted reassurance. Your brain treats the unknown as danger and control as safety — so you check, suggest, remind, and steer, all while telling yourself you are just being caring. Start naming the actual feeling underneath: "I am anxious because I do not know how this ends." That sentence, said honestly to yourself, is the beginning of the end of the pattern. You cannot manage anxiety you keep mislabeling as helpfulness.

2 Requests that leave room for a real no

A request leaves room for a real no; pressure does not. Compare: "I would feel better if you texted when you arrive — would you be willing?" versus "You never text, you clearly do not care how I feel." The first states your need and grants autonomy; the second punishes and corners. Practice the structure: your feeling, your request, genuine acceptance of refusal. "I get worried when plans change last minute. Could you give me a heads-up when you can? If not, I will manage." The last sentence is the whole game — it proves the request was a request. Track your ratio for a week: every time you steer, ask whether a no was actually available.

3 How to stop after stating a concern once

State your concern once, then stop — this is the single highest-leverage change you can make. The pattern to break is the follow-up volley: the reminder text, the "just checking," the bringing it up again at dinner, the worried face that continues the conversation silently. After you have said the thing clearly and kindly, your work is done; repetition does not increase influence, it increases resentment. When the urge to repeat rises, write the unsent text in your notes app instead. Read it tomorrow — you will usually find that silence did the job better than the fourth reminder would have.